

Word family: **procrastinate** / procrastinates / procrastinated / procrastinating / procrastination / procrastinator

Base word: procrastinate

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

procrastinate (v.) — 拖延；把該做的事一再推遲

procrastinated (past/participle) — 拖延了

procrastinating (gerund/participle) — 正在拖延

procrastination (n.) — 拖延；拖延習慣

procrastinator (n.) — 習慣拖延的人

chronic procrastination — 長期拖延

procrastinate on something — 拖延處理某事

procrastinate about something — 對某事遲遲不行動

procrastinate instead of doing something — 拖延而沒有去做某事

Meaning in this passage

> Of course, I still **procrastinate** sometimes, because nobody is perfect...

Here, **procrastinate** means:

delay doing something you know you should do, usually without a good reason — 明知應該做，卻一再拖延

The speaker still sometimes postpones tasks, but now knows how to recover before things get out of control.

中文翻譯：

當然，我有時候還是會**拖延**，因為沒有人是完美的。

So here:

procrastinate = 明明知道事情應該現在做，卻不必要地把它推遲到之後

1. **procrastinate** — 拖延；遲遲不做

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I still **procrastinate** sometimes.

我有時候還是會**拖延**。

Practice 2

> I always **procrastinate** when I have a difficult assignment.

遇到困難作業時，我總會**拖延**。

Practice 3

> Stop **procrastinating** and start your work.

別再**拖延**了，開始工作吧。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastinate = 明知某件事需要做，卻不必要地延遲開始或完成

2. **procrastinate over / about something** — 對某事遲遲不行動

Practice 1

> She **procrastinated over the decision** for weeks.

她為這個決定**拖了幾星期都遲遲不下決定**。

Practice 2

> He kept **procrastinating about applying for the job**.

他一直**拖延申請那份工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastinate over/about X = 對 X 一再拖延，不願及時採取行動

3. **procrastinate on something** — 拖延處理某事

Common, especially in AmE.

Practice 1

> I **procrastinated** on the report until the night before it was due.

我一直**拖着不做報告**，直到截止前一晚。

Practice 2

> Don't **procrastinate** on important tasks.

不要**拖延處理重要任務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastinate on X = 把應該處理的 X 一再推遲

4. **procrastinate instead of doing something — 拖延而不做正事**

Practice 1

> I spent an hour scrolling online instead of working—I was just **procrastinating**.

我花了一小時上網滑手機而沒有工作，其實只是在**拖延**。

Practice 2

> He cleaned his desk instead of studying because he was **procrastinating**.

他沒有溫習，反而去整理書桌，因為他在**拖延正事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastinate = 用其他較容易或較舒服的事情代替真正需要做的工作

5. **procrastination — 拖延；拖延習慣**

Practice 1

> **Procrastination** caused most of my last-minute stress.

拖延造成了我大部分最後一刻的壓力。

Practice 2

> Better planning helped reduce my **procrastination**.

更好的規劃幫助我減少**拖延**。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastination = 一再把應該做的事情推遲的行為或習慣

6. **chronic procrastination** — 長期 / 慣性拖延

Practice 1

> **Chronic procrastination** can create unnecessary pressure.

長期拖延會製造不必要的壓力。

Practice 2

> She is trying to break the cycle of **chronic procrastination**.

她正嘗試打破**慣性拖延**的循環。

MCQ-ready definition:

chronic procrastination = 長期反覆把重要事情推遲的習慣

7. **a tendency to procrastinate** — 拖延傾向

Practice 1

> I have a **tendency to procrastinate** when a task feels overwhelming.

當任務令人不勝負荷時，我有**拖延的傾向**。

Practice 2

> His **tendency to procrastinate** affected his work.

他的**拖延傾向**影響了工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

a tendency to procrastinate = 經常傾向把事情推遲的習慣性模式

8. **procrastinator** — 愛拖延的人；拖延者

Practice 1

> I'm a terrible **procrastinator**.

我是個很嚴重的**拖延者**。

Practice 2

> Even a **procrastinator** can learn better time-management habits.

即使是**很愛拖延的人**，也可以學會更好的時間管理習慣。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastinator = 經常把需要做的事拖到之後的人

9. **procrastination cycle** — 拖延循環

A useful psychological/educational expression.

Practice 1

> Stress can create a **procrastination cycle**.

壓力可以形成一個**拖延循環**。

Practice 2

> Breaking tasks into smaller steps helped me escape the **procrastination cycle**.

把任務拆成較小步驟，幫助我擺脫**拖延循環**。

MCQ-ready definition:

procrastination cycle = 拖延導致壓力，而壓力又進一步令人拖延的重複模式

10. **productive procrastination** — 生產性拖延

A modern informal/psychological expression.

Practice 1

> Cleaning the kitchen instead of writing the essay was a form of **productive procrastination**.

不寫作文而去清理廚房，是一種**生產性拖延**。

Practice 2

> **Productive procrastination** still avoids the main task.

生產性拖延雖然做了其他有用的事，但仍然是在逃避主要任務。

MCQ-ready definition:

productive procrastination = 為了逃避最重要的工作而去做其他看似有用的事情

Important distinction 1: **procrastinate** vs **delay**

This is the biggest distinction.

delay

neutral: make something happen later.

procrastinate

unnecessarily put off something you know you should do.

> The storm delayed the flight.

> 暴風令航班延誤。

> I procrastinated and started the essay too late.

> 我一直**拖延**，結果太遲才開始寫作文。

So:

procrastination usually implies avoidable personal delay

Important distinction 2: **procrastinate** vs **postpone**

postpone

deliberately move something to a later time, often for a valid reason.

procrastinate

keep putting it off, usually because you do not want to start.

> postpone the meeting because of illness

> 因病押後會議

> procrastinate on preparing for the meeting

> 遲遲不準備會議

Important distinction 3: **procrastinate vs put off**

put off

very broad phrasal verb meaning postpone.

It can be neutral or deliberate.

procrastinate

specifically suggests habitual/unnecessary avoidance.

> We put off the trip because of the weather.

> 因天氣而押後行程。

> I kept procrastinating on my homework.

> 我一直拖着不做功課。

Important distinction 4: **procrastinate vs avoid**

avoid

try not to do or face something at all.

procrastinate

intend or need to do it eventually, but keep delaying.

> avoid the conversation

> 避開對話

> procrastinate before having the conversation

> 遲遲不肯開始那場對話

Important distinction 5: **procrastinate vs hesitate**

hesitate

pause because you are unsure, nervous, or reluctant.

procrastinate

delay over a longer period instead of taking action.

> hesitate before answering

> 回答前猶豫一下

> procrastinate for three weeks

> 拖了三星期

Important distinction 6: **procrastinate vs be lazy**

These are not the same.

lazy

unwilling to make effort generally.

procrastinate

delay a particular task, often even while doing other things.

A hardworking person can still procrastinate on stressful or unpleasant tasks.

Important distinction 7: **procrastination vs poor time management**

They overlap, but are not identical.

procrastination

actively or habitually delaying action.

poor time management

broader problem with organizing time.

Poor time management may include:

- * bad scheduling,
- * underestimating time,
- * overcommitting,
- * procrastination.

Your passage actually includes several of these at once.

Important distinction 8: **procrastinate vs miss a deadline**

procrastinate

behaviour before the deadline.

miss a deadline

final outcome.

You can procrastinate and still meet the deadline.

That is exactly why your passage says:

> I still procrastinate sometimes

even though the speaker is now much better at getting back on track.

Important distinction 9: **procrastinate does not require doing nothing**

A person may procrastinate by:

- * checking messages,
- * cleaning,
- * organizing folders,
- * watching videos,
- * doing easier tasks.

So:

procrastination = avoiding the priority task, not necessarily complete inactivity

Important distinction 10: **procrastination vs perfectionism**

They can be connected but are distinct.

perfectionism

setting extremely high standards or fearing imperfection.

procrastination

delaying action.

Perfectionism can sometimes cause procrastination because starting feels risky or difficult.

Important distinction 11: **procrastination vs distraction**

distraction

something pulls attention away.

procrastination

the broader behaviour of delaying work.

A distraction can contribute to procrastination, but one moment of distraction is not necessarily procrastination.

Important distinction 12: **procrastinate is usually intransitive**

Natural:

- > I procrastinate a lot.
- > I procrastinated on the essay.
- > I procrastinated about making the decision.

Less natural for general learners:

> *I procrastinated the essay.* ❌

Use ****on/about/over****, or simply use the verb without an object.

Important distinction 13: ****procrastination is usually uncountable****

Natural:

> Procrastination is a problem.

> My procrastination got worse.

Usually not:

> *a procrastination* ❌

though specialized contexts can use countable instances very rarely.

Family-extension note

****Procrastinate**** has one very stable modern semantic core:

****unnecessarily delay doing something that you know you should do****

It branches mainly by context rather than by completely different meanings:

1. ****general delay****

* procrastinate

2. ****specific task****

* procrastinate on something

* procrastinate about doing something

3. ****habit****

* procrastination

* chronic procrastination

4. ****person****

* procrastinator

5. **behavior pattern**

* procrastination cycle

* productive procrastination

Unlike **fire**, **clock**, or **responsibility**, **procrastinate** is not heavily polysemous. Its learner value lies mainly in distinguishing it precisely from **delay**, **postpone**, **put off**, **hesitate**, **avoid**, and **laziness**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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procrastinate	拖延	unnecessarily delay action
procrastinate on X	拖延處理 X	delay a task
procrastinate about X	對 X 遲遲不行動	delay decision/action
procrastinating	正在拖延	ongoing delay
procrastination	拖延；拖延習慣	behaviour
chronic procrastination	長期拖延	persistent pattern
tendency to procrastinate	拖延傾向	habitual tendency
procrastinator	拖延者	person
procrastination cycle	拖延循環	self-reinforcing pattern
productive procrastination	生產性拖延	useful avoidance activity

For your original sentence

> Of course, I still **procrastinate** sometimes, because nobody is perfect, but the difference is that now I know how to get back on track before everything spirals out of control.

Here:

procrastinate = 我有時仍然會明知事情應該開始做，卻把它拖到之後才處理

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當然，我有時候還是會**拖延**，因為沒有人是完美的.....

The cleanest contrast is:

> **delay** = 令事情變遲，原因可以很中性

> **postpone** = 有意識地正式押後

> **procrastinate** = **明知應該做，卻不必要地一再拖延**

And the sentence importantly shows that:

procrastination has not disappeared completely; what changed is the speaker's ability to recover before the delay becomes a crisis.